



**INDIAN INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY
MADRAS**

BS in Data Science & Applications
SPG Project May 2026

GP-1 SUBMISSION

Navigating Algorithmic Anxiety

Evaluating the Role of a Growth Mindset in Managing Workplace Stress and Skill Obsolescence in the Age of Generative AI.

Project Charter, Team Profile & Discussion Plan

Team Number	Team 52
Project Title	Navigating Algorithmic Anxiety
Domain	Resilience • Technological Literacy • Lifelong Learning • Stress Management • Growth Mindset
Submission Date	4 th July 2026



Project Management Plan

Goal, Scope and Work Breakdown Structure

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Goal & Scope

- **Goal:** To evaluate how cultivating a growth mindset can help mitigate workplace stress, counteract perceived skill obsolescence and prevent emotional exhaustion among working professionals adapting to advancing Generative AI integration.
- **Scope:** Conducting qualitative research via semi-structured interviews with 5 working professionals across diverse domains. This study will not gather quantitative survey data, nor will it evaluate specific technical features of the AI tools themselves.

Work Breakdown Structure





Project Management Plan

Contingency Plan and Google Sheets Task Management Snapshot

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Contingency Plan

- **Ghosting:** Each member should identify a "Backup Participant" to ensure 5 interviews are completed by Week 4.
- **Emergencies:** If a member faces an emergency, some of their tasks can be redistributed among the remaining 4 members to meet the deadline.
- **Deadlines:** Stricter internal deadlines that are at least 2 days prior to the submission deadline to avoid any last-minute hassles.

Google Sheets Snapshot https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1LY636vx_1pFBH7o0bPnazhaYznTKru8f03-mSQAQoBA/edit?usp=sharing

Task	Assignees	Start	End	Status	Gantt	WBS Phase
SPG Project		6/15/2026	8/1/2026			
Project Title and Description	Rishi Shrinidhi Hariom Harsh Ashirwad	6/20/2026	6/27/2026	Overdue		Planning
Self Assessment	Rishi Shrinidhi Hariom Harsh Ashirwad	6/20/2026	6/27/2026	Completed		Planning
Team Contract	Rishi	6/20/2026	6/27/2026	Completed		Planning
Project Management Plan	Rishi	6/27/2026	7/4/2026	Active		GP1
Work Breakdown Structure	Rishi	6/27/2026	7/4/2026	Active		GP1
Team Profile	Rishi Shrinidhi Hariom Harsh Ashirwad	6/27/2026	7/4/2026	Active		GP1
Primary Resource	Rishi Shrinidhi Hariom Harsh Ashirwad	6/27/2026	7/4/2026	Active		GP1
Secondary Resource	Rishi Shrinidhi Hariom Harsh Ashirwad	6/27/2026	7/4/2026	Active		GP1
Discussion Plan & Questions	Rishi Shrinidhi Hariom Harsh Ashirwad	6/27/2026	7/4/2026	Active		GP1
GP1 report	Rishi Shrinidhi Hariom Harsh Ashirwad	6/27/2026	7/4/2026	Active		GP1
Conducting Interviews	Rishi Shrinidhi Hariom Harsh Ashirwad	7/4/2026	7/11/2026	Upcoming		Execution
Summarizing Interviews	Rishi Shrinidhi Hariom Harsh Ashirwad	7/11/2026	7/18/2026	Upcoming		Execution
Qualitative Analysis	Rishi Shrinidhi Hariom Harsh Ashirwad	7/11/2026	7/18/2026	Upcoming		Analysis
GP2 Report Creation	Rishi Shrinidhi Hariom Harsh Ashirwad	7/18/2026	7/25/2026	Upcoming		GP2
Presentation	Rishi Shrinidhi Hariom Harsh Ashirwad	7/25/2026	8/1/2026	Upcoming		GP2



Team Profile

Get to know us

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Rishi Jain (Lead)

DS 21f1002476
ENFJA

- ★ BTech CS 24, IIIT
- ★ Freelancer



Hariom Kumar

DS 23f2004225
INTJA

- ★ Passionate about Data Science & Analytics



Ashirwad

DS 23f2000650
INTPA

- ★ BTech CS 27, CMRIT
- ★ Interested in AI & Backend



Shrinidhi Kumar

DS 23f1002153
INFJA

- ★ MSc Data Science, MIT WPU
- ★ Reliance Scholar
- ★ AI Engineer, Atomic Loops



Harsh Vardhan

DS 24f1002285
INFJT

- ★ Director & Tech Lead AI, Backend...

Team Diversity Analysis

- The team includes students, freelancers, tech leaders, and industry professionals.
- Blend of leadership (ENFJ), strategic thinking (INTJ), analytical problem-solving (INTP), and empathy (INFJ).
- Common background in technical fields.

Strengths

- Different perspectives and experiences
- Analytical & research mindset.
- Balanced leadership and teamwork.

Weaknesses

- Limited diversity outside the AI/tech domain.
- Small team with similar expertise.

Opportunities

- Apply concepts to research.
- Strengthen communication, teamwork, and professional skills.

Threats

- Time constraints & coordination challenges.
- Bias from similar backgrounds.



Topic Alignment & Resources

Why this topic & resources for the study

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Topic Alignment

- **“Navigating Algorithmic Anxiety: Evaluating the Role of a Growth Mindset in Managing Workplace Stress and Skill Obsolescence in the Age of Generative AI.”**
- The topic for this study is rooted in course themes like **Stress Management (Week-12)** and **Personal Growth and Transformation (Week-9)**, by evaluating how adopting a growth mindset could deter workplace stress. This study, also, explicitly connects to the WEF Future of Jobs skills, especially **resilience, flexibility & agility, technological literacy** and **lifelong learning**.

Primary Resources:

IT industry professionals are particularly susceptible to AI-related stress due to the rapid integration of AI in their work, making them highly relevant for the study

Name	Designation	Company	Domain	Exp (yrs)	By
Gaurang Saraswat	Software Engineer	Hewlett-Packard, India	Information Technology	3+	Rishi Jain
Kartikeya Pandey	AI Engineer	JensCoder	Information Technology	1+	Shrinidhi Kumar
Manoj S V	Software Engineer	Oddrv	Product Development	1+	Ashirwad
Rahul Kumar	DBA	STC	Information Technology	12+	Hariom Kumar
Sri Ram Venkatesh	Director	Crifter Enterprise	Project Management	5+	Harsh Vardhan



Secondary Resources

- **Reich, A., Wolfe, D., Price, M., et al. (2026).** Psychological safety as the key to AI transformation. arXiv Cornell University. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2602.23279>
- **Sinha, S., & Sharma, A. (2025).** Artificial intelligence and the perception of workplace stress in employees. The International Journal of Indian Psychology, 13(2). <https://ijip.in/wp-content/uploads/2025/04/18.01.083.20251302-1.pdf>
- **Xu, G., Xue, M., & Zhao, J. (2023).** The association between artificial intelligence awareness and employee depression: The mediating role of emotional exhaustion and the moderating role of perceived organizational support. International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health, 20(6), 5147. <https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph20065147>
- **Zheng, J. (2025).** Association between AI awareness and emotional exhaustion: The serial mediation of job insecurity and work interference with family. Behavioral Sciences, 15(4), 401. <https://doi.org/10.3390/bs15040401>



Discussion Plan & Draft Questions

Around 10 draft questions

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Discussion Plan

Welcome & Orientation: Share project goals, secure permission to record, guarantee anonymity and establish baseline context (industry, role, current AI usage).

Core Questions:

1. **Stressors:** map fear of skills obsolescence from rapid AI rollouts.
2. **The Toll:** document technostress, cognitive fatigue...
3. **Buffers:** identify how a growth mindset drives active experimentation over paralysis.
4. **Probing:** Apply the 5 Whys technique to dig beneath surface-level responses.

Wrap-up & Closing.

Draft Interview Questions

1. How did you react when a new AI tool was first introduced to your team's daily workflow?
2. Has AI given you more free time, or has it just made your deadlines faster?
3. How did it feel when an AI tool easily did a task you spent years mastering?
4. Can you describe a time you felt overwhelmed trying to keep up with constant AI updates?
5. Does your stress about AI at work spill over into your personal life and free time?
6. How does your stress level compare when an AI makes a mistake versus a human teammate?
7. What do you think separates colleagues who welcome AI from those who aggressively resist it?
8. When an AI tool failed during an experiment, did you feel safe sharing that failure with your team?
9. Are you still motivated to learn new professional skills if AI can do them instantly?
10. What personal barriers would stop you from fully participating in a company AI training program?